

Parks Department Meeting April 15th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bDKS-Ko7f4w
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Muny Parks and Recreation Board Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: April 15, 2025

Board: Muny Parks and Recreation Board

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the meeting to order at [00:00:28](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** James Letton, Mark Irvin, Shannon P, Brad Marshall (Presiding Officer).
 - **Absent:** Chandra Park (excused due to a family commitment).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The board stood for the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:32](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the March meeting were approved by voice vote ([00:01:30](#)).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:39 Superintendent Report: Park Conditions and Operations**
 - **Presenter:** Carl Malone, Superintendent.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff have been busy clearing storm debris and downed trees, including two trees down at McCullum Park. Staff met with the youth program "Teen Works" regarding summer employment and program coordination. The parks department is currently down three employees, plus one major medical leave expected to last until late summer (July), and is actively processing seasonal hiring to run from May 1 to Labor Day. Pickleball nets are installed at Riverside Park, and pre-startups for splash pads (Riverview, Thomas Park, Halterman, and Kulie) are scheduled to begin next week, targeting a Memorial Day opening. The splash pad motor at Thomas Park has arrived, and main water lines are being tested. The old roof at the TUI bath house is being repaired with financial contributions from Community Development, while park staff work on interior water fountains and showerheads. Westside softball field's sewer line has ongoing issues, and a quote has been received from J-Bird for an overall fix. Skatepark opening dates are to be announced. Playground mulch is being replenished across parks.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal board vote taken.
- **00:12:37 Programming Updates & Event Approvals**
 - **Presenter:** Nikki Ericson, Program Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Muni Teen internship program completed interviews and selected 110 youth out of 148 applicants. National Kids to the Park Day is scheduled for May 17 at Canon Commons (12:00 PM <U+2013> 4:00 PM). The NFL flag football program runs from May 14 through June, with parent meetings on May 7 at Heekin Park. Several event requests and modifications were presented:
 - **Muni Black Expo Date Change:** **00:15:15** Request to move dates from July 17<U+2013>20 to July 31<U+2013>August 2 to avoid conflicts. No change in scope or vendors.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (**00:15:57**).
 - **Everlasting Superator Inc. (Zion Strong):** **00:16:13** Request for a 5-on-5 basketball tournament at McCullum Park from June 20<U+2013>22, expecting 70<U+2013>100 people, with security and small business/food vendors. Requesting two sets of bleachers.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (**00:18:24**).
 - **Halterman Village Neighborhood Association:** **00:18:37** Request for a neighborhood park party on Saturday, June 21 (event 11:00 AM <U+2013> 3:00 PM; area use 8:00 AM <U+2013> 5:00 PM) with a rain date of June 22. Requesting two park-owned portable toilets, extra trash cans, and stocked restrooms.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote, with the stipulation/amendment that the association pay the cleaning fees associated with the portable toilets (00:26:01).
 - **America<U+2019>s Hometown Band of Muny:** 00:16:30 (*Note: chronologically discussed around 00:26:30*) Request for free public concerts at Westside Park on July 24, August 14, and August 21 (150 expected attendees), requesting stage sections.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote, with the stipulation and amendment that security is required and must be provided before the event dates (00:28:47).
 - **Jar Community Church:** 00:29:00 Request for Halterman Splash Pad area on May 31 from 1:00 PM <U+2013> 3:00 PM for a free community event (50<U+2013>60 attendees), providing private security (retired officer) and handing out popsicles. No park resources requested.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (00:30:02).
- 00:30:34 **Prairie Creek Report**
 - **Presenter:** Tony (Prairie Creek Staff).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff are working on installing docks, which has been delayed due to high water levels, damaged pier replacements under warranty, a broken maintenance boat, and a staff member's home being impacted by a tornado. Nighttime security is enhanced this year (two guards covering shifts from 4:00 PM to 10:00 PM, and 1:00 AM to 6:00 AM). New lighting repairs are underway via Indiana Michigan Power. The campsite lottery was completed, filling all sites with one alternate used. Dock assignments are currently being called through. Security gates are currently non-operational because one was hit by a driver; staff are looking for a new contractor to repair them. Additional event requests were presented:
 - **Fishers American National Tournament Trail (Indiana North Division):** 00:41:09 Request for August 9 (5:45 AM <U+2013> 4:00 PM) at the boat launch parking area for a fishing tournament (under 30 people).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (00:42:16).
 - **Old National Bank Employee Picnic:** 00:42:28 Request for June 21 (2:00 PM <U+2013> 5:00 PM, shelter rental noon to 5:00 PM) for approximately 50 employees.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (00:43:31).
 - **Chariots of Fire Church Revival:** 00:43:47 Request for a 3-day church revival event by the beach near the bathrooms from June 12<U+2013>14 (events in evening; requesting overnight tent access for one person to watch \$10,000 in equipment).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote under current event rates (00:52:04).

- **Family Reunion Shelter Rental:** 00:53:14 Family reunion shelter rental on August 9 from 10:00 AM <U+2013> 6:00 PM for approximately 60 people (exceeding shelter capacity of 40).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote, applying an event fee in addition to the shelter rental fee due to exceeding shelter size limits (00:54:11).
 - *Guest Presentation:* Roger from Catfish Pirates and Amvets Post 12 introduced their 6th annual veterans benefit catfishing tournament scheduled for May 24 (Memorial Day weekend), highlighting veteran support programs, free food, and a touch-a-truck military/first responder presence.
- 00:10:42 **Old Business: Summer Program, TUI, and Cardinal Swim Contracts**
 - **Presenter:** Carl Malone / Board Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding the TUI and Cardinal swim contracts. Board members expressed frustration that the annual contracts were signed/processed by administration without prior board review or oversight in the November<U+2013>December timeframe. Staff confirmed legal (Aubrey) reviewed and approved the TUI contract, and it will be forwarded to the board immediately. The Cardinal Swim Club contract was submitted to their board last week.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** No formal vote; contracts to be distributed to board members for review.
- 00:12:16 **Old Business: Westside Skate Park Update and Rules**
 - **Presenter:** Carl Malone / Skate Club Representative (Todd Swackhammer / Coalition).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of proposed rules for the new Westside Skate Park. The board discussed the need for formal signage referencing Indiana Code 34–13–3–3 (extreme sports liability protection), operating hours (dusk to dawn vs. city park 11:00 PM closing), and police dispatch contact numbers. A representative of the newly formed Muny Skate Park Coalition spoke in favor of community involvement, maintenance support, and establishing clear safety protocols.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to accept the rules framework with additions (state code reference, dusk-to-dawn clarification, and dispatch number) to be forwarded for city council codification (00:15:43 / 01:25:40).
- 01:28:49 **New Business: Prairie Creek Shore Fishing Enhancements**
 - **Presenter:** Joe Kacharski (Sail Club / Volunteer).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented concepts and architectural handouts for enhancing shore fishing at Prairie Creek Reservoir (placing modular floating dock platforms 20 feet offshore to improve accessibility for mobility-impaired individuals, keep fishing hooks away from sailboat docks, and provide deeper water access). Estimated costs range from \$8,000 to \$15,000 per installation. Also briefly discussed a potential future model radio-controlled sailboat regatta in collaboration with the Academy of Model Aeronautics.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken.
- **01:39:29 New Business: Pool Admission Price Increases**
 - **Presenter:** Nikki Ericson / Carl Malone.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to increase public pool admission prices by \$1 (Adults: \$6, Teens: \$5, Children/Seniors: \$4, Infants: Free) to help offset rising operational and chemical costs. Board members debated whether increased revenue returns to the parks department budget or the city's general fund, and ultimately decided to table a final vote until next month to allow discussions with the city controller and city council regarding budget allocation.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Held/Deferred for further discussion next month.
- **01:51:47 New Business: Indiana American Water Prairie Creek Discussions**
 - **Presenter:** Board Members / Carl Malone.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding recent meetings between the city, parks staff, and Indiana American Water regarding Prairie Creek Reservoir. Water quality, runoff, erosion, and recreational growth/amenities (such as private piers and trails) were raised as primary concerns by the water utility. Representatives from Indiana American Water are expected to make a formal presentation at the May parks board meeting.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational update; no formal vote.
- **01:56:13 Old/New Business: Trash Interlocal Agreement with Muny Sanitary District**
 - **Presenter:** Carl Malone / Board Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of the interlocal trash agreement between the Muny Sanitary District and the parks department running through December 31, 2029. The agreement includes \$52,000 annually for tree removal services. Board members raised minor questions regarding the disposition/reversion of park trash trucks if the agreement is terminated.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Placed on agenda for priority decision/vote next month.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **02:01:44 John Reer:** Spoke regarding Prairie Creek Reservoir, noting that fishing is exceptional (walleye and crappie) but pointing out that the safety rail on the ADA fishing pier is too high (chest-high), making it difficult for seated or handicapped individuals to fish. He also suggested establishing an emergency boat ramp at the dead end of Burlington road for wind/storm rescues, and requested more trash cans near high-traffic fishing areas.
- **02:11:32 Nikki Warren King:** Spoke as a lifelong resident and former police officer regarding historical access to Prairie Creek. Raised concerns about the loss of shore-fishing access due to overgrowth, brush piles blocking fishing spots, and limited parking

near bridges, emphasizing the need to preserve public access alongside recreational development.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** The next regular board meeting is scheduled for May. Indiana American Water will present at the May meeting, and pool/contract items will be revisited.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote at [02:28:03](#).
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